Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 59 Number 3 Circulation: 1,650 March 2015 Sunnyvale, California Editor: Phyllis Fowler

Monthly Meeting: Wednesday, March 11th

At 7:00 pm at the Lakewood Park Building

Our Topic: Update from the LVNA Elections & Sunnyvale Community Services

Check out our website: www.lvna.net
Facebook Group page: Lakewood Village LVNA



President's Message

By Fred Fowler

March meeting: Election time!
By Fred Fowler

Greetings Neighbors!

The LVNA year has come full circle and it is time to elect the board for the 2015/2016 term. Each year in March we hold elections to select the people who will act in the neighborhood's interest for the next twelve months. Come to the Lakewood Park Building on Wednesday, March 11th to participate in the selection process and make your voice heard.

Last year we elected one returning board member and four new ones. Our 1st Vice President Wendy Stanley has just completed her 3rd term on the board, whereas the rest of us will be starting our 2nd terms if we are re-elected. Returning board members this year are 2nd Vice President Pat Muniz, Treasurer Dess Tamez, Secretary Phyllis Fowler, and me, LVNA President Fred Fowler.

Since Wendy has now served three years in a row, the LVNA bylaws state that she must drop off the board for at least a year to make room for someone else to step up. We are very lucky to have had long-time LVNA resident John Thornton throw his hat into the ring! John has lived here most of his life and let me know a few weeks ago that he is interested in serving. His name will be on the ballot on the 11th, as well as that of Pat, Dess, Phyllis and I.

(Continued on page 3)

The LVNA Year in Review

By Fred Fowler

Greetings neighbors. February is the last month of the 2014-2015 LVNA year, and during the last board meeting the LVNA officers looked back on the accomplishments we achieved during that period. We decided to look back and consider what went well, what didn't go so well, what initiative we should drop and what new things we should try.

WHAT WENT WELL

This past year was a very successful one for the LVNA. We tried some new ideas and also improved on some old ones. Here is the list (in no particular order) of some of the things that went well for us.

(Continued on page 3)

Free Tax Assistance 2
Year in Review (continued) 3
CNC Classes 4
Police Blotter 6

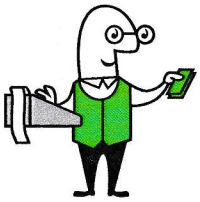


Newsletter Walkers Needed for Lakewood Routes!

We are looking for walkers for the Fairwood side. It takes about 1/2 an hour to walk a route and you get the benefits of meeting your neighbors, getting landscaping ideas, and, best of all, fresh air and exercise.

It's only once a month, usually the 1st or 2nd weekend. If interested, please call Fred at (408) 505-2813 ◆

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Free Tax Filing Service

When: starting February 21.
Dates are 2/21, 3/7, 3/14, 3/28. 4/4
Time: 10 am – 2 pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
739 Morse Ave

Tax Aid, a free tax service for families with annual incomes of $52,000 or less, returns to CNC.

Appointments are first come, first served between 10 a.m. and 2 p.m. Visit **tax-aid.org** or contact CNC to find out what documents are required for your appointment. ◆

Library Make-HER Space for Girls

This spring, the Library will become a Make-HER space for girls interested in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math). A tech-savvy team of LadyMakers will lead girls ages 8 - 12 and their moms through fun and creative engineering, circuitry, and design challenges. Register online at **Sunnyvale.ca.gov** and go to the library page. and follow the progress of our Make-HER girls. This program series is supported by a Pacific Library Partnership Innovation and Technology Grant. ◆

Free Parent Workshops



Romance of Risk: Talking to your Teen about Risky Behavior and Wise Decisions

When: May 26th
Time: 6:30 – 8:30pm
Where: Sunnyvale Public Library

Smoking, drinking and sexual behavior and drug use are all hot topics that merit discussion, but often set up defense mechanisms and road blocks to effective communication. Learn how to help your teen make responsible decisions regarding risky behaviors and relationships. Cynthia Klein is a Certified Parent Educator, coach, speaker and author who works with parents of young children to adult children to provide solutions to parenting challenges that are individualized, unique, effective and enduring. ◆

Friends for Youth Mentoring

Friends for Youth, a non-profit organization, matches trained adult's mentors to youth in need of positive adult role models. The commitment for both parties is for one year, spending about 3-4 hours per week in various activities. For more information, call the Columbia Neighborhood Center at (408) 730-7800 ◆



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The LVNA Year in Review

(Continued from page 1)

Adding Goodwill to Dumpster Day.

The LVNA has been holding Dumpster Day in conjunction with Specialty Waste and Recycling and the City of Sunnyvale for at least the past 25 years. This year we decided to add a new partner to the mix: Goodwill of Santa Clara County.

For years we've seen many good and usable items go into the Dumpsters. We've tried various ways to rescue them and get them into hands that want them. We've tried the Garage Sale, working with vendors to take our used bicycles and even having a "free" pile of goods available for the taking. None of those ideas panned out very well. In the end too many of the items ended up in the Dumpsters (and then the landfill) despite our best efforts.

This past year we hit upon the idea of asking Goodwill to station some of their collection trailers in the neighborhood on Dumpster Day. The results were very surprising to them! In just the one day we gave them a little over eight tons of usable items! In return they paid us about $3,000, which has left the LVNA treasury very healthy as a result. Goodwill was so excited that the asked to present us their check at a meeting of the Sunnyvale City Council. They wanted to have the LVNA set an example for other neighborhood associations in Sunnyvale and show them what was possible in their own neighborhood cleanup events.

This coming Dumpster Day we plan to expand our cooperation with Goodwill. We're talking with them about accepting furniture as well as the standard smaller items they normal take (clothing, toys, books, housewares, etc.). Stay tuned!

Hot August Nights Car Show.

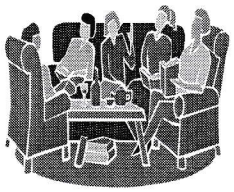
Another new initiative that worked out well was holding the "Hot August Nights" car show at the Lakewood Shopping Center. We held it on the day of "National Night Out"; a nationwide event where neighbors are encourages getting out of their houses and "taking back" the evening hours for family centered activities. We decided to drop our annual picnic and hold this event instead and try something new.

The results were very gratifying. We cleared out a large space in the Lakewood Shopping Center parking lot and made room for more than 30 classic cars.

Specialty Solid Waste and Recycling very generously donated the cost of a professional stage and sound system and a wonderful band (Idol Hands) provided music for the event. Lots and lots of people turned out! In the end we were asked by many of the classic car owners whether we could expand the event for next year. Several city officials (including the Mayor, the Vice Mayor, several City Council members, the City Manager and the Chief of DPS) commented on how much they enjoyed themselves. It looks like we've begun a new LVNA tradition! I think we will do even better next August.

(*Continued on page 5)*

President's Message



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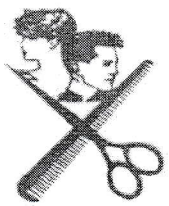
By the way, if YOU would like to serve, it is not too late to stand for election. Come to the LVNA meeting on the 11th and put you name forward! Nominations "from the floor" will be accepted during the meeting, and in pure democratic tradition the candidate with the most votes will be the winner.

(To be perfectly honest, I'm not in need of serving as President again. I've done it three times now and I know how it all works. I'll serve again if no one else wants the challenge, but if someone feels ambitious and wants the opportunity to serve Lakewood Village in this way, I'll be happy to step aside!)

Once the elections are over we'll welcome a guest speaker from Sunnyvale Community Services. Our guest will fill us in on the services the agency provides, the challenges it faces and important tips about what it can do for people in need. Their presentations are always interesting and we're glad to welcome them back.

--Fred ◆

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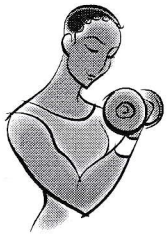
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Columbia Neighborhood Center

Near Columbia Middle School at 739 Morse Ave.
For information on programs, contact CNC at (408) 730-7800 or CNC@sunnyvale.ca.gov, or see CNC.**inSunnyvale.com** for a full list of programs and times.

Fitness Room Orientations: Sign up for a one-hour orientation to the CNC Fitness Room. Various times are available in both English and Spanish. Learn how to use the equipment to have the most effective workout **Drop-in Fitness Room**



When: Every Monday & Thursday
Time: 6:30 – 8 pm
When: Every Tuesday
Time: 7:30 – 9 pm
When: Saturdays from
Time: 8 – 9:30 am and 10:30 am to noon
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: $1.00 per participant—cash only

The program is staffed by an attendant who is First Aid and CPR certified. Participants must prove they live in Sunnyvale. Middle School students can participate if accompanied by a parent/guardian. High School students can participate if a parent/guardian signs the waiver/ consent form. Forms must be completed before participation. Participants should wear athletic shoes, and bring water and a towel. ◆

Youth Drop-In Gym



Basketball: Fridays 7 – 10 pm
Indoor Soccer: Mondays 7 – 9 pm
Saturday 7—10 pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: 50¢ per visit for residents ($1 for non-residents).



Must be Middle or High School student. **School ID REQUIRED for entry!**

Drop-In Gym will be cancelled if there are no participants in the first hour. ◆

Free Legal Clinics



When: February 7th & March 7th
Time: 10 am – Noon
Where: Columbia Neighborhood
Cost: Free!

Columbia Neighborhood Center and South Asian Bar Association of Northern California partner to provide free legal clinics. Get a 20 – 30 minute legal consultations on any legal matter, provided by a licensed attorney. ◆

Zumba Classes



When: Wednesdays at 7-8 pm
Fridays from 6-7pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: $1.00 per person per visit

Adults and children over 10 years of age. (with an adult/guardian) are invited to participate. There is **no childcare**, children are not allowed to wait in the gym or lobby because of child endangerment issues parents should not leave their children without adult supervision inside or outside the Center. ◆



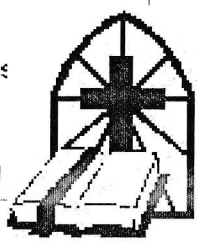
Bilingual Story Time

When: Thursday
Time: 4 – 5 pm
Where: Columbia School Library

Fun and games with one of Sunnyvale's bilingual librarians.◆

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11:00 a.m. Worship Service
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7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting





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The LVNA Year in Review

(Cont. from page 3)

WHAT DIDN'T GO SO WELL

Not everything we tried worked out as well as we expected. That's ok. We learn more from our mistakes than from our successes. A wise man once told me that if everything you try works then you are not being bold enough. We should not be afraid to attempt something just because it might fail. If it does, we must learn our lesson and move on.

Daytime LVNA meeting

Most of you may not remember that during the summer we tried an experiment. Our LVNA general meetings have always been held in the evening (7:00pm). Several of our active volunteers and newsletter walkers had complained that those evening hours were hard on families with young children. 7:00pm – 8:00pm is bath and bed time for toddlers and elementary school kids, so the parents of those children (who ironically have the most at stake in our neighborhood and its livability) were prevented from taking part in this important LVNA Activity

We decided to address this issue by trying to start a appropriate reading material to neighborhood elementary school kids during the summer months. Those volunteers include Pat Muniz, the LVNA 2nd Vice President, and so far they have gathered more than 200 at the Lakewood and Fairwood schools to identify kids who would benefit from the reading material. Watch for updates on this exciting new initiative!

Sunnyvale Community Services "Back to school Backpacks" drive.Last summer the LVNA helped organize the donation of some backpacks for kids headed back to school. These backpacks held school supplies; such are pencils, paper, rulers and other items needed by young students. Sometimes families find it challenging to provide supplies on their own. Sunnyvale Community Services collects these backpacks and distributes them to families in need.

This year we want to expand on last year's program. One idea is to use some of the proceeds of this coming year's Dumpster Day/Goodwill event to purchase backpacks and school supplies, rather than simply asking for donations. We'll see! Stay tuned for more information as the year progresses.

The 2014-2015 year was a very good one for the LVNA. We tried a number of new things, and the result was increased participation in many LVNA events. Our monthly meetings were better attended than they have been in years, our Facebook and Website pages have been getting hits and our newsletter is being widely read. The LVNA is on the move, and the future looks bright.

I look forward to working with you all during the coming year. Thanks in advance for your help. ◆

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Neighborhood Crime Corner

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Weapon Violation – 160 Persian
Thursday February 5 @ 12:02am
Officers responded to the Brass Rail on a report of a subject carrying a firearm inside the establishment. Officers located the suspect and determined he was displaying a replica firearm. The suspect was arrested for the weapon violation and for violating his parole.

Residential Burglary – 1300 Blk. Sandia
Friday February 6 between 12:20 – 12:40pm
Unknown suspect entered the residence by prying open a bathroom window and fled on foot when the resident returned home. Jewelry, cash and electronics were stolen from the residence.

Outside Fire – Caribbean & 237
Wednesday January 28 @ 12:19am
DPS, San Jose Fire, and San Jose PD responded on reports of a fire somewhere north of the Baylands. It was determined to be a bulldozer on fire, and it was in San Jose jurisdiction.

Residential Burglaries – 600 Blk. Bonanza Ct.
Wednesday January 28 @ 9:58am
An unknown suspect entered a residence by breaking out a glass door to the rear of the house. The suspect was confronted by the homeowner, who was inside the house, and fled on foot. While in the neighborhood, it was determined that another house had been broken into but nothing was stolen.
Thursday January 29

Residential Burglary – 1200 Blk. Manzano
Friday January 30 @ 1/29 11:50am – 1/30 12:33pm
Unknown suspect entered the residence by prying open a bedroom window and stole electronics and liquor.

Auto Burglaries - 150 Lawrence Station Rd.
Monday February 2 between: 6:40pm – 7:30pm
Several auto burglaries occurred in the parking lot of Costco. All of the victim vehicles had laptop computers on a seat in plain view. NOTE: Residents are reminded to store valuable items under a seat or in the trunk . ◆

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Public Safety - Emergency	911
Public Safety - Non-emergency	730-7100
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints—Desk Officer	730-7110
Neighborhood Preservation Complaints on decrepit fences, , weeds, illegal home businesses or rentals	730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
Public Works- sidewalks, trees, streetlights, etc.	730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline & Shopping Cart Pickup	730-7680

Street Sweeping:

Fairwood Side - 3/10 & 3/24 & 4/7
Lakewood Side - 3/17 & 3/31 & 4/14

LVNA Contacts:

President - Fred Fowler
email: fmfainc@gmail.com
Editor - Phyllis Fowler sunnyphyl@gmail

Newsletter Delivery:

Fairwood Side - Fred Fowler (408) 505-2813
Lakewood Side- Wendy Stanley (408) 745-1331

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To submit articles or letters for publication, please contact the editor before the 28th of each month
Send your document or inquiry to Phyllis Fowler: sunnyphyl@gmail.com